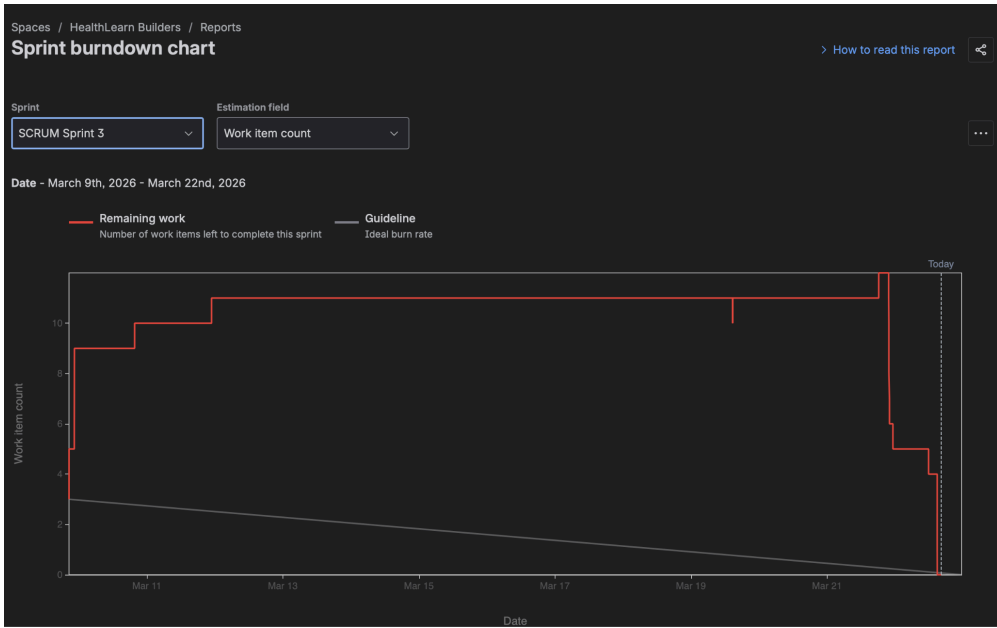


Burndown Chart Reflection

Burndown Chart



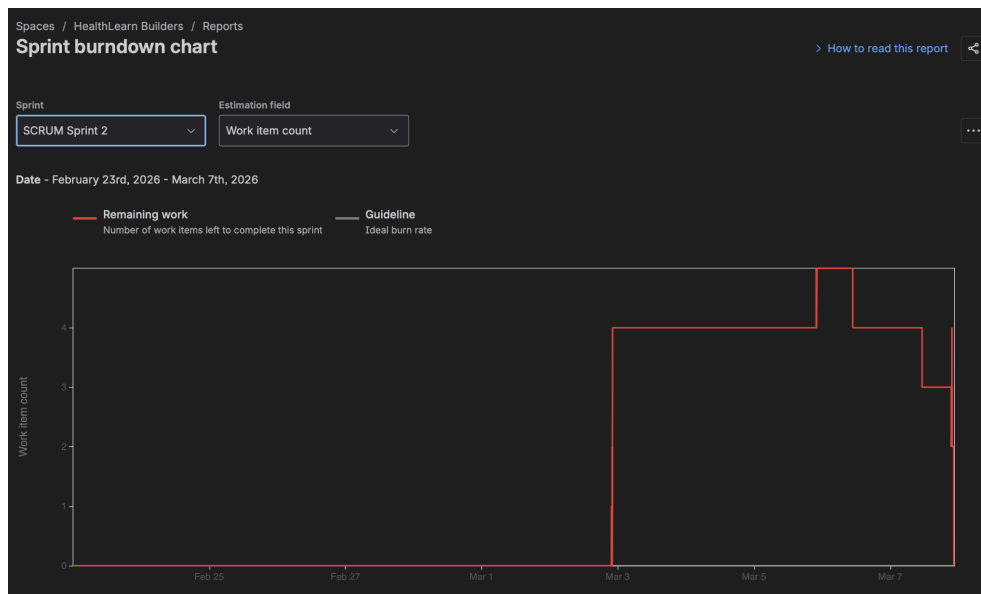
SPRINT 3 BURNDOWN CHART

[Figure 1: Jira burndown — Sprint 3 (Mar 9 – Mar 22, 2026). Estimation: work item count.]



SPRINT 3 BURNDOWN CHART

[Figure 1: Jira burndown — Sprint 3 (Mar 9 – Mar 22, 2026). Estimation: story points.]



SPRINT 2 BURNDOWN CHART

[Figure 2: Jira burndown — Sprint 2 (previous sprint) (Feb 23–Mar 7, 2026). Estimation: work item count.]

(ps. since the sprint 2 we didn't know we need to add the story points as we mentioned before, so I didn't provide the burndown chat for sprint 2 by the story points)

Reading the chart (work item count)

The grey guideline assumes a steady burn from the starting backlog to zero. Our actual remaining work rose early (roughly 4 → 9–11 items), then stayed flat for most of the sprint, and fell sharply on the last day to zero. Interpreting this in work-item terms (not story points), the team did deliver everything by the close, but progress appears back-loaded, and the early increase suggests more issues entered the sprint scope after day one (new work, splits, or bugs).

Reading the chart — Sprint 3 (story points)

The grey guideline starts near 9 story points on Mar 9 and slopes linearly to 0 by Mar 22, representing an ideal steady burn.

The red remaining work line does not follow that ideal path. On Mar 9, remaining story points jump from 0 to roughly 19, then to about 31, and continue to rise over the next few days—reaching about 34 by Mar 11 and peaking near 37 by Mar 12. That early increase is classic scope growth relative to the guideline baseline (~9 points): the sprint backlog gained work after the sprint started (new stories, discovered work, or re-estimation).

From Mar 12 through Mar 21, remaining work stays flat at ~37 story points, indicating little or no story points were burned in Jira during most of the sprint—either because work was blocked, stories were too large, progress was not updated continuously, or delivery time was compressed by external constraints.

On Mar 22, remaining work spikes briefly to about 40 points (likely last-minute scope or splitting/re-estimation), then drops sharply in steps until it reaches 0 at sprint end. The sprint meets the “zero remaining” outcome, but the shape is heavily back-loaded (“hockey stick”), not an incremental burn-down.

Sprint context (why the shape may look “unhealthy”)

We also faced heavy coursework pressure from multiple term tests during Sprint 3. As a result, we prioritized finishing features and closing tickets in the final stretch of the sprint, when we had larger blocks of time to integrate, test, and update Jira. That pattern can produce a “hockey stick” burndown even when work is real: issues stay open until the end, then move to Done quickly.

What we take from this

Going forward, we will still aim to close smaller slices mid-sprint (or update board status more frequently) so the chart reflects incremental progress, not only end-of-sprint batching—while recognizing that exam weeks may continue to compress our delivery rhythm.

Sprint velocity vs. previous sprint — using work items

Why work items: Sprint 2’s burndown was based on work item count. Sprint 3’s burndown chart is based on story points and the work item count, so the curves are not directly comparable. To compare Sprint 3 with Sprint 2 on the same basis, we use work items from Jira.

completion: Sprint 3 closed all committed work in Jira (0 remaining story points at sprint end), whereas Sprint 2 left two work items open when the sprint closed. At the same time, Sprint 3’s burndown shape still shows uneven progress over time, similar in spirit to Sprint 2—most visible burn-down happens late, even though the outcome is stronger.

In Sprint 2, our burndown used work item count rather than story points (see the visualization note for that sprint). The chart showed remaining work near zero early, then a rise to about four items around Mar 3, with a short move toward five, and only a drop near the end; two items remained incomplete at closeout. That pattern is consistent with scope entering the sprint after planning, tickets split or added mid-sprint, and/or board updates that did not reflect a stable backlog from day one—so part of the sprint effort went to discovery, fixes, and re-scoping rather than a smooth, even burn. It also means Sprint 2’s velocity, in work-item terms, was held back by unfinished work at the deadline.

In Sprint 3, we switched the burndown to story points for this sprint. The team had a clearer backlog of implementation work (for example, patient-facing flows such as appointments and payment integration, therapist-facing dashboard work, and stabilizing features merged from parallel branches). The grey guideline starts near 9 points, but actual remaining work jumps early to the ~19–31 range and peaks near ~37 by Mar 12, which indicates substantial scope growth right after sprint start (new issues, underestimated work, or re-estimation). For most of the sprint (Mar 12–Mar 21), the line stays flat, then drops sharply on Mar 22 to zero, including a brief spike toward ~40 points—so delivery is real, but recorded and integrated largely at the end. Mid-sprint term tests also reduced continuous coding time, which contributed to batching completion and status updates toward the sprint deadline.

Any changes and reasons why

Measurement change: Sprint 2 used work item count; Sprint 3 used story points to reflect effort and the Jira guideline. Velocity is not one-to-one comparable across sprints—compare completion and trends, not a single merged metric.

Sprint 3 — scope went up early: Story points jumped right after start (guideline ~9 vs actual ~19–37), with a late spike (~40) before 0. Reasons: new/clarified work after planning, splits/re-estimates, and merged features entering the tracked backlog mid-sprint.

Sprint 3 — flat middle, cliff at end: Little burn for most of the sprint, then a sharp drop on the last day. Reasons: term tests reduced steady dev time; large / end-to-end stories finished in integration & testing late; Jira updates may have been batched instead of daily.

Sprint 2 — work items: Count rose mid-sprint; 2 items unfinished. Reasons: late tickets, scope added, or underestimated test/polish.

Takeaway: Scope discipline, smaller stories, and frequent board updates next sprint to avoid back-loaded burndowns.